

Cybersecurity for SME Employees

Module 2.5 – Reporting Incidents and Red Flags

1 Objective

Empower employees to recognize and report cybersecurity incidents or suspicious activity without fear of blame or punishment.

2 Introduction

Every employee plays a vital role in identifying and reporting cyber threats. Timely reporting helps prevent damage, stop attacks early, and improve company security. This module covers what to report, how to report it, and how a no-blame culture encourages a safer workplace.

3 Why Reporting Matters

- Early detection can prevent data loss and breaches.
- Small indicators (like suspicious emails) might signal larger threats.
- Unreported issues can escalate into serious incidents.

4 What Should You Report?

- Suspicious emails, links, or attachments.
- Unexpected software installations or pop-ups.
- Devices acting strangely or slowing down suddenly.
- Lost or stolen devices.
- Unauthorized access or login attempts.
- Accidental data sharing or exposure.

5 How to Report an Incident

- Follow the company's official incident reporting process.
- Use designated platforms or email addresses (e.g., `security@yourcompany.com`).

- Provide details: what happened, when, on which device/system.
- Don't try to fix or hide the issue—report first.

6 Creating a No-Blame Reporting Culture

- Mistakes happen—even clicking a phishing link.
- Encourage openness without punishment.
- Learning from incidents helps improve everyone's security awareness.
- Recognize and reward responsible reporting.

7 Red Flags to Watch Out For

- Urgent requests asking you to bypass security rules.
- Unfamiliar login alerts.
- Emails from coworkers asking for sensitive data but written oddly.
- Pop-ups prompting you to enter login credentials.
- Antivirus or firewall alerts.

8 Example Scenario

Ravi receives an email claiming to be from IT asking him to reset his password using a link. It looks suspicious, but he hesitates to report it, fearing he might look careless. Later, a colleague clicks a similar link, compromising their account. If Ravi had reported it, the IT team could have warned everyone and prevented the breach.

9 Conclusion

Recognizing and reporting suspicious activity is one of the most effective ways to defend your organization. With a no-blame, supportive culture, employees become active defenders against cyber threats. The next module will dive into how attackers manipulate people using social engineering tactics.